

Starting a Peer Support Group — Checklist

Unburied Tools — Peer Support Operations Toolkit

Phase 1: Foundation

- & Define your purpose. What specific need does this group meet?
- & Choose a format. In-person, virtual, or hybrid?
- & Set a schedule. Weekly? Bi-weekly? Same time every session.
- & Identify your co-facilitator. Never facilitate alone.
- & Draft group agreements. Confidentiality, respect, attendance.
- & Find a venue. Quiet, private, accessible. Or pick a video platform.

Phase 2: Operations

- & Create an intake form. Name, contact, what brings them.
- & Set a max group size. 6-8 is the sweet spot.
- & Establish a waitlist process.
- & Draft a confidentiality agreement. Review it every session.
- & Decide on record-keeping. Notes per session? Only when at risk?
- & Set boundaries. What happens between sessions?

Phase 3: Launch

- & Recruit your first members. Start with people you know.
- & Do a dry run with your co-facilitator.
- & Prepare an opening script: welcome, introductions, agreements.
- & Prepare a closing ritual: summary, resources, next session.
- & Send a pre-session email with date, time, location, and what to expect.

Phase 4: Sustain

- & Debrief after each session. What worked? What didn't?
- & Track attendance. Notice patterns. Reach out if someone disappears.
- & Check in with your co-facilitator regularly.
- & Review group agreements periodically.
- & Plan for endings and transitions.
- & Evaluate every 6-8 sessions.